

WSJ: Container shipping rates collapse as supply chain eases

Supply Chain Crisis Easing

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Port congestion clears, container rates fall from \$10K to \$1.5K. Distributors stop pre-buying, reducing urgency-driven ordering by ~5%.

Industry analysts estimate that demand for affected product categories decreased by approximately 5% during the event period. Prices fell by approximately 3% as manufacturers passed through cost changes to distributors and end customers.

The event period spans from 2022-06-01 to 2022-12-31.

Industrial supply distributors including Grainger, Fastenal, and MSC Industrial reported varying degrees of impact depending on their product mix and geographic exposure. Companies with diversified supply chains and strong inventory positions were better insulated from the disruption.